

O wizen eyes resplendent

In memory of Robert Coon (1931 - 2021)

Text: Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

Music: Gustav Holst, 1921

THAXTED 13.13.14.12.13.14

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at the beginning of each measure. The lyrics are written in three parts (1, 2, 3) below the staff, with some words hyphenated across lines. The score consists of six systems of music and lyrics.

1 O wiz - ened eyes re - splen - dent, we seek the things you saw,
2 O ea - ger lips of bless - ing, speak grace for us to - day,
3 O trem - b'ling hands of ser - vice, wrap arms a - round us all.

that urged you to such great - ness, and hum - bled you in awe.
for - give us and our mourn - ing, our stub - born, pet - ty ways.
Take res - pite from your la - bors, and joy in heav - en's call.

We strive now, as you once strove, toward the bea - con, toward the Light.
We speak now, as you once spoke, prayers and stor - ies, ho - ly jest,
We fight now, as you once fought, not with sword, but plow - share hewn.

With fore - bears in - vit - ing, it beck - ons yet more bright.
to bol - ster worn hearts and in - spire us to our best.
Through clang - or - ous war drums you hummed a dif - f'rent tune:

Though tear - y eyes may hin - der, and sor - row shroud our way,
You ut - tered bless'd ass - ur - ance, through strife, your words did calm,
Ev - 'ry note is one of jus - tice, each tear can shat - ter chains,

what seems to us like eve - ning may just be break of day.
there is a - far in Gi - le - ad, vouch - safed for us a Balm.
ev - 'ry sigh be - comes a rush of wind, set free a - cross the plains.